

Help for Caregivers

Caring for a loved one is a huge job — and you deserve support too. There's free help, a break (respite), and even ways to get paid for caregiving. Below are trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

You can't pour from an empty cup. The resources below help you find support, take breaks, and in some cases get paid for the care you provide. Start with the Eldercare Locator — it opens many doors.

1 Start Here — Find Local Support

One call connects you to local caregiver services, respite, and guidance.

☐ Eldercare Locator

Connects you to local Area Agencies on Aging, caregiver support, and respite services.

→ eldercare.acl.gov 1-800-677-1110

☐ Caregiver Action Network

Free education, a help desk, and peer support for family caregivers.

→ www.caregiveraction.org 1-855-227-3640

2 Get Paid for Caregiving

In many cases, family caregivers can receive payment through Medicaid or the VA.

☐ Medicaid Self-Directed Care

Many states let people on Medicaid hire and pay a family member as their caregiver. Ask your state Medicaid office.

→ www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/long-term-services-supports/self-directed-services

☐ VA Caregiver Support

The VA offers stipends, training, and support for those caring for eligible veterans.

→ www.caregiver.va.gov 1-855-260-3274

☐ Paid Family Leave (Your State)

A growing number of states offer paid leave to care for a seriously ill family member. Check your state's program.

→ www.dol.gov/agencies/whd/fmla

3 Take a Break (Respite Care)

Respite gives you time to rest while your loved one is cared for safely.

☐ ARCH Respite Locator

Find respite-care services that give caregivers a much-needed break.

→ archrespite.org/caregiver-resources/respitelocator

4 Support for You

Caregiving is emotionally hard — these offer connection and guidance.

☐ Family Caregiver Alliance

Education, support, and state-by-state resource navigation.

→ www.caregiver.org

☐ Condition-Specific Caregiver Help

Groups like the Alzheimer's Association (1-800-272-3900) offer free 24/7 caregiver support.

→ www.alz.org/help-support

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Don't fall for "caregiver grant" offers that charge a fee — real programs are free. And don't wait until you're burned out to ask for respite; taking breaks helps both you and the person you care for.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Ask your state Medicaid office specifically about "self-directed" or "consumer-directed" care — it's how many family members get paid to provide care they're already giving.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need local caregiver help?

This guide covers national starting points. For respite, paid-caregiver programs, and support groups near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll help you find the closest options.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
